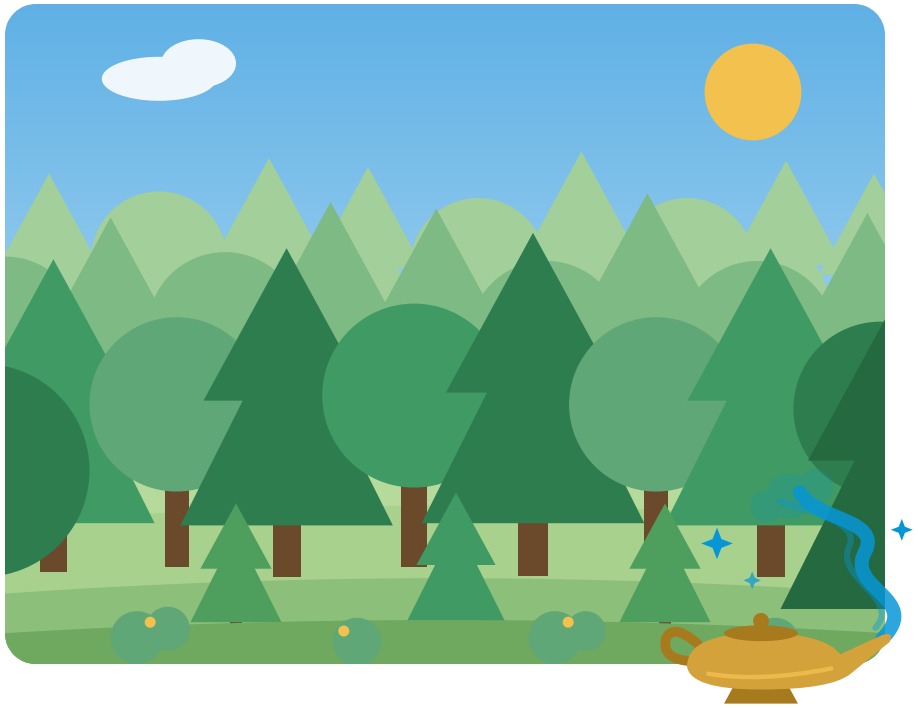
AUTODESK



KENT BECK'S KEYNOTE, RETOLD

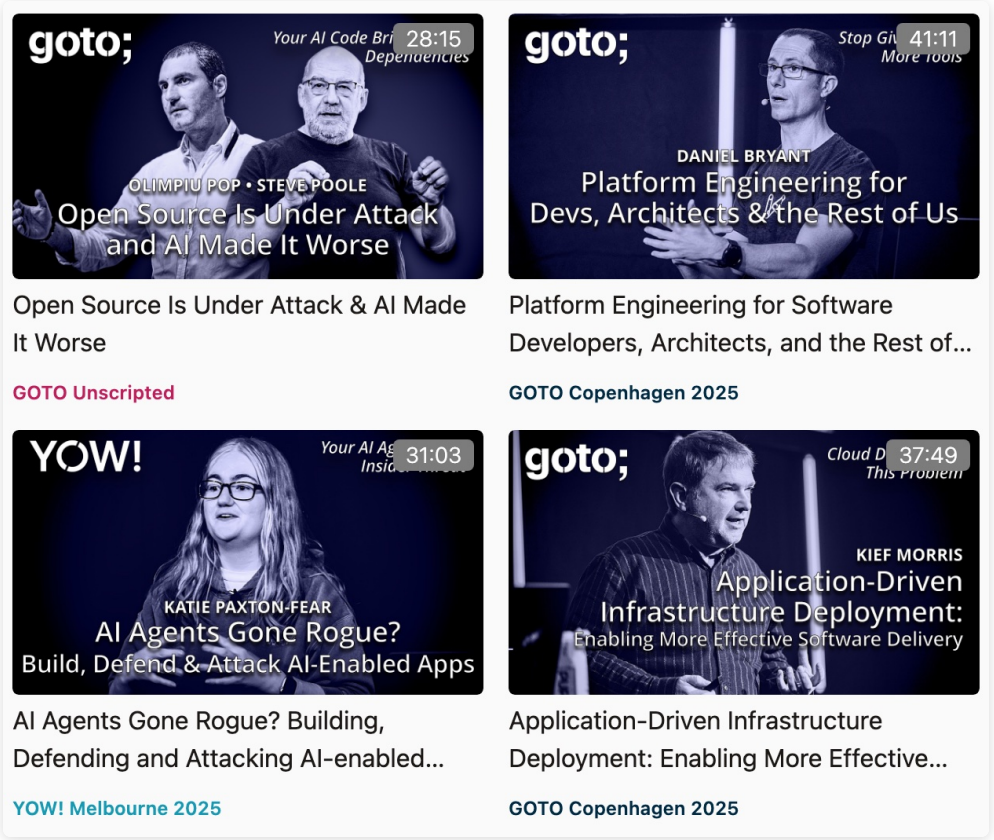
The Augmented Forest

Forests, deserts and genies

GOTO Copenhagen 2026



At GOTO Copenhagen 2026



GOTO talks on gotopia.tech

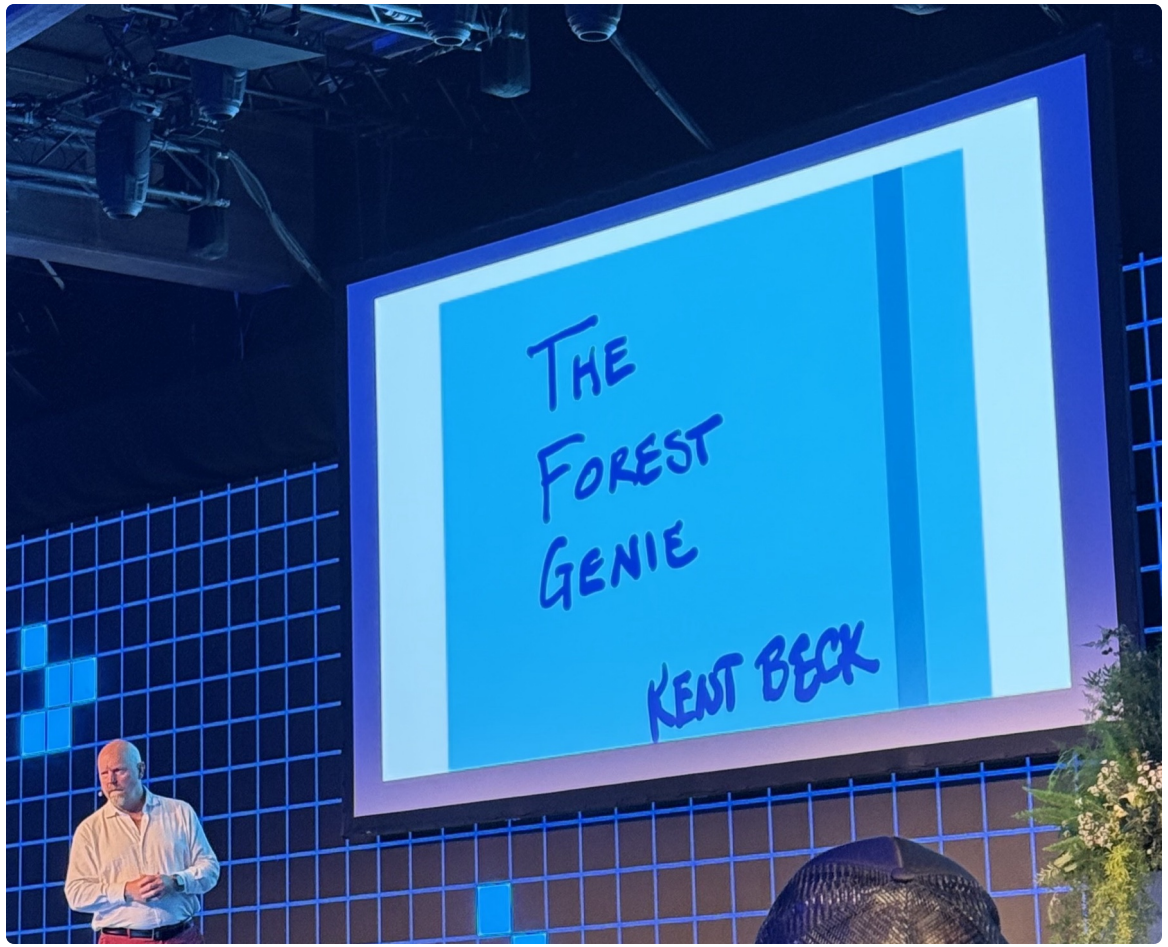
Kent Beck



Photo: Robert Opiyo, via kentbeck.com

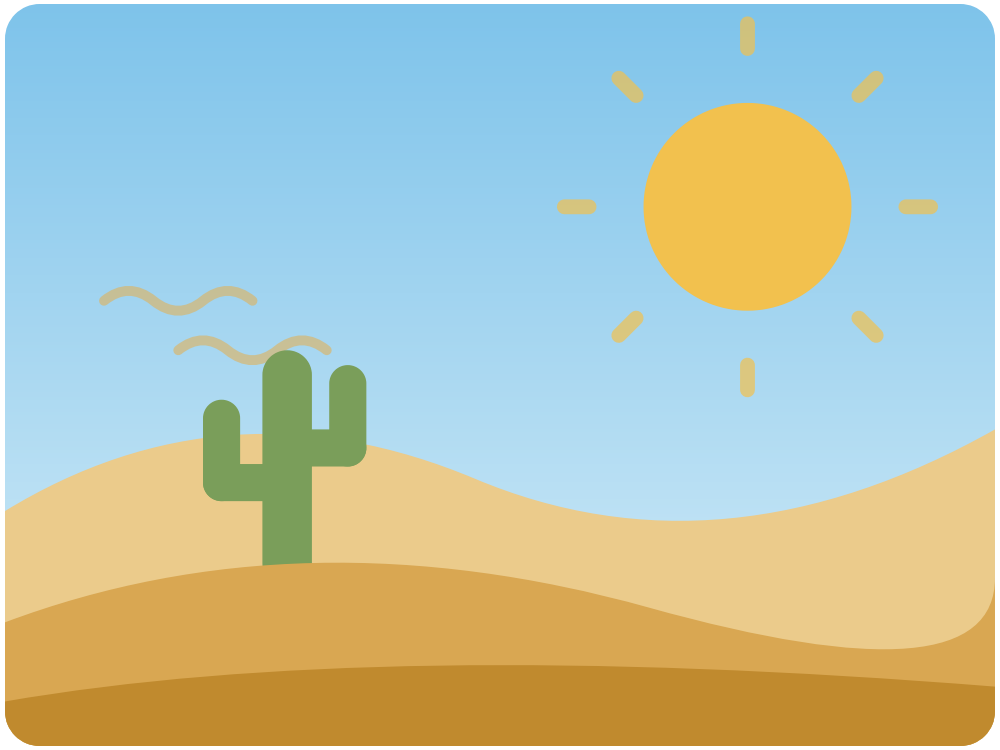
- **Extreme Programming**
  Created on Chrysler's C3 project, 1996 · *Extreme Programming Explained*, 1999
- **Test-driven development**
  Test-Driven Development: By Example, 2002
- **Agile Manifesto**
  One of the 17 original signatories · Snowbird, Utah, February 2001
- **Tidy First?**
  Book (O'Reilly, 2023) and newsletter · codes with genies every day

Beck's keynote



GOTO Copenhagen, 2 October 2026 on stage

Two landscapes



Deadlines · bugs · painful on-call · change is the enemy

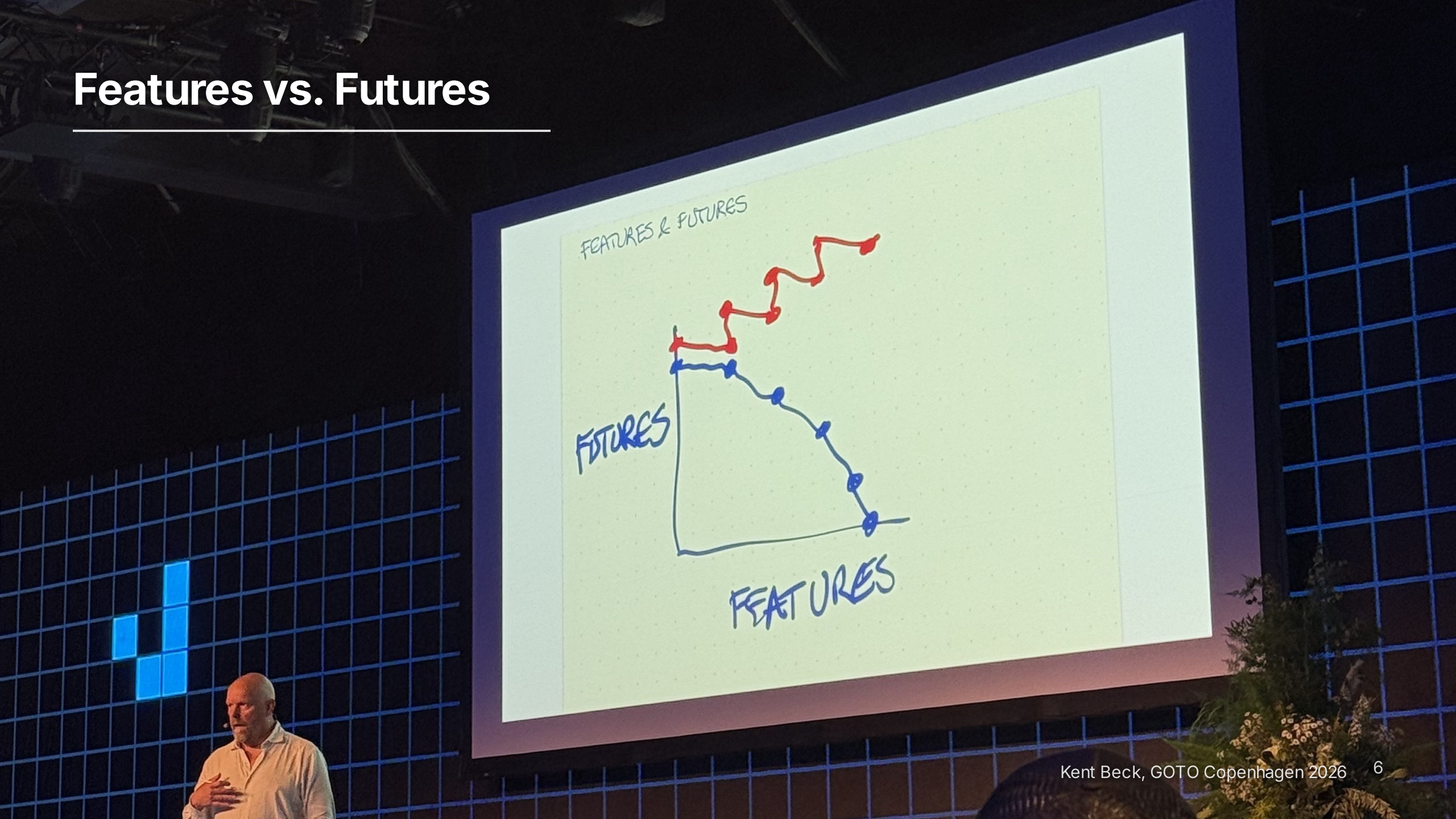
Runs on fear



Small safe steps · tests · rare bugs · change is expected

Runs on trust

Features vs. Futures

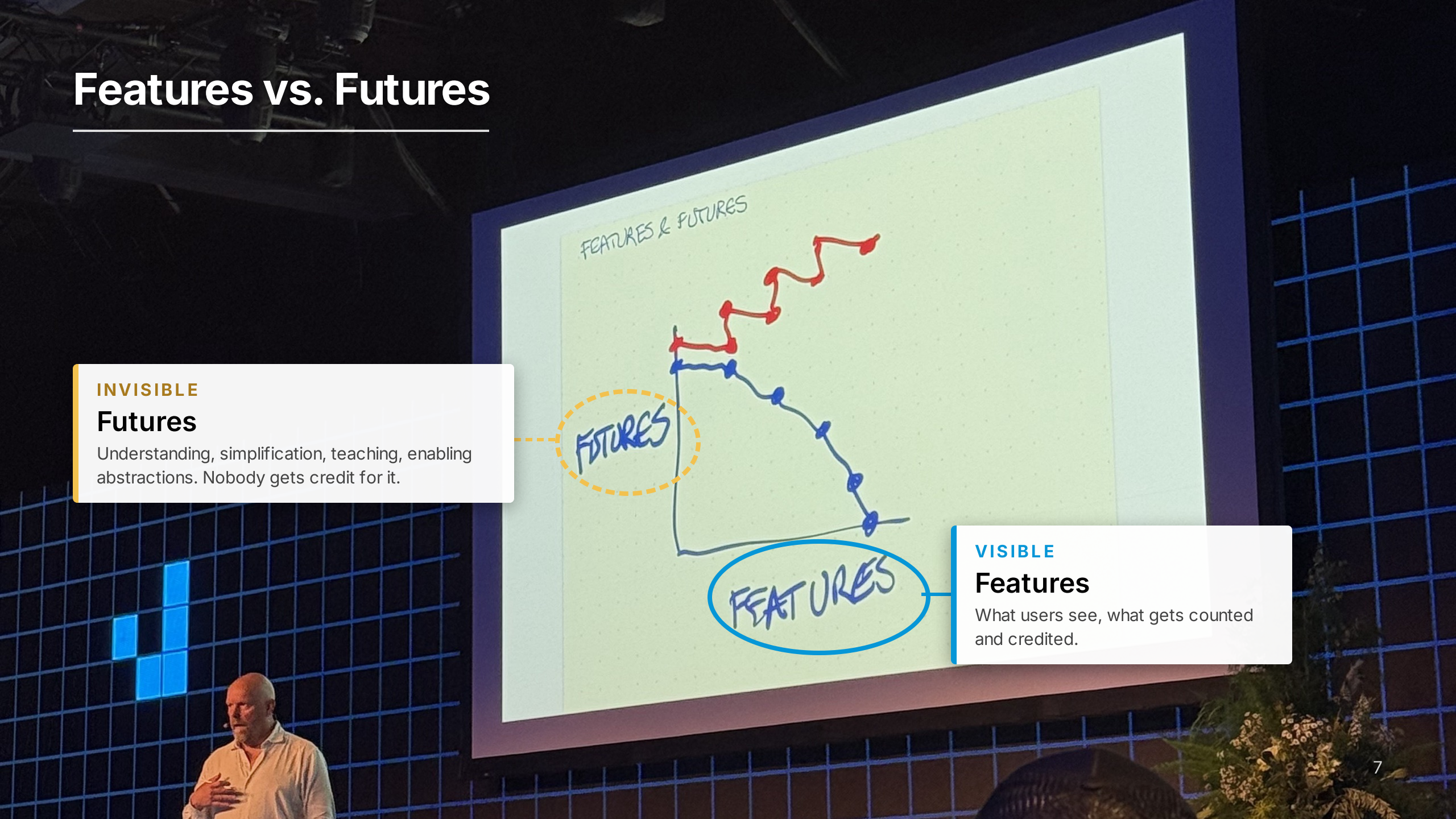


Features vs. Futures

INVISIBLE

Futures

Understanding, simplification, teaching, enabling abstractions. Nobody gets credit for it.



VISIBLE

Features

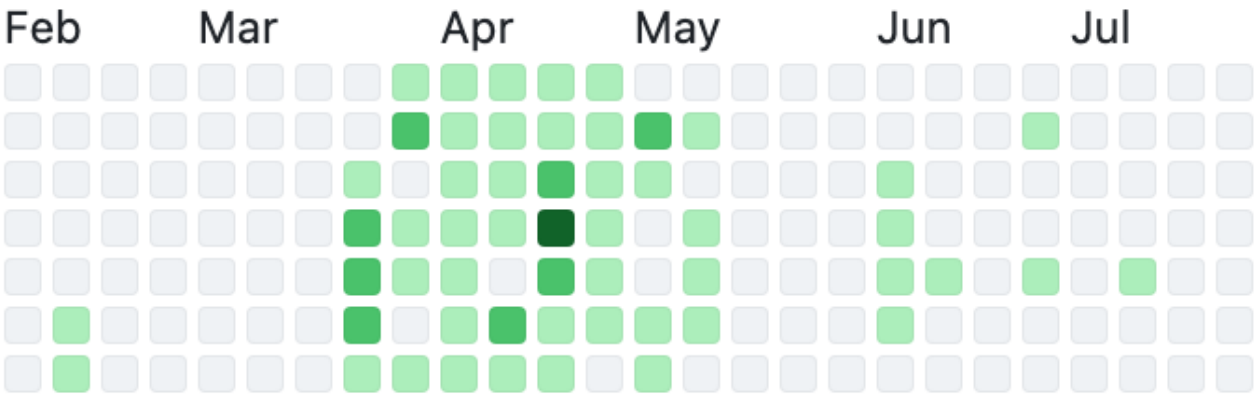
What users see, what gets counted and credited.

The Genie



"Sometimes it's useful, and sometimes it's damaging."

Kent Beck on AI coding agents



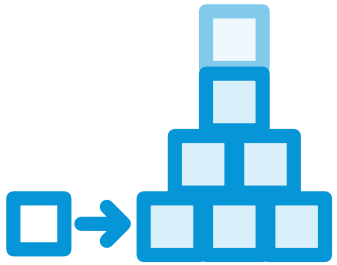
Kent's GitHub contributions, Feb–Jul 2026: 495 on 54 days, 301 of them in April. Each square is one day; the greener, the more commits, pull requests, issues and reviews that day. Source: github.com/kentbeck

How genies misbehave



It cheats

deletes the failing test



It overreaches

grants wishes you didn't make



It degrades

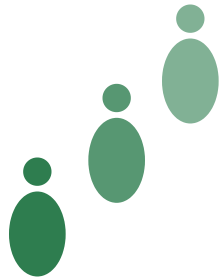
the genie tarpit

Taming the genie



Tests

the wish, written down



Small steps

short leash, cheap to undo



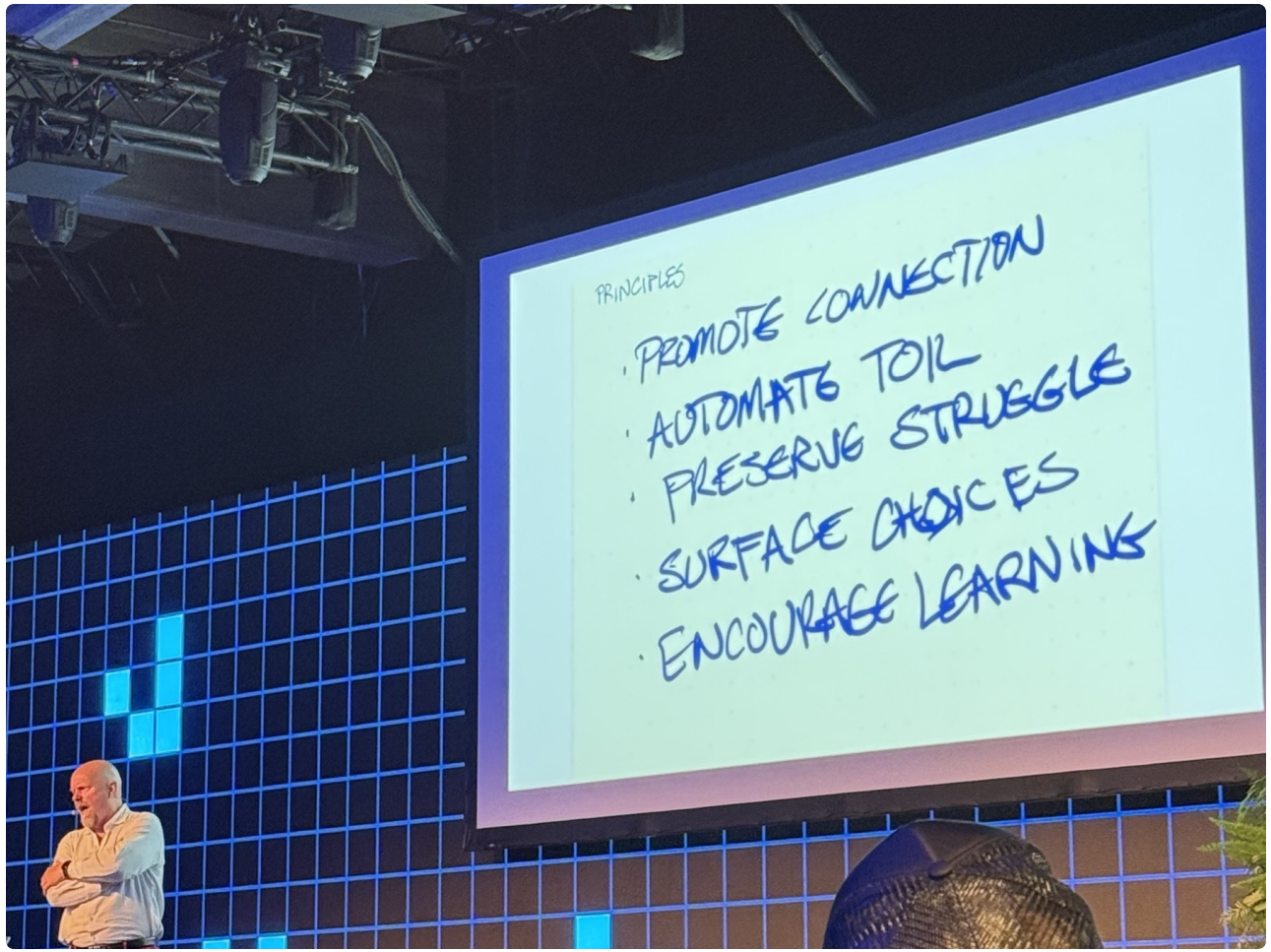
Watch it

read the diff

The genie intensifies



Five principles



Further deep dive

WATCH

- Features vs. Futures: Software Design in the Age of AI
  Kent Beck · ShipSummit, Rise8 · thumbnail title: "Do Unit Tests Still Matter?"
- TDD, AI agents and coding with Kent Beck
  The Pragmatic Engineer podcast
- Genie Sessions: Can You Force a Genie to Do TDD?
  Kent Beck, live coding with an agent

THE KEYNOTE

- The Augmented Forest, GOTO Copenhagen 2026
  Also at SPLASH/ISSTA 2026 · doi.org/10.1145/3837729.3850163

READ

- Forest & Desert
  Beth Andres-Beck, guest post on Kent's newsletter, 2024
- Forest And Desert
  Martin Fowler's short summary of the metaphor
- Earn *And* Learn
  Kent Beck on features and futures
- Mathematicians, Here's a Way To Think About Your Existential Crisis
  Kent Beck on visible and invisible work, 2026
- Kent Beck's genie posts
  Including *Genie Tarpit* and *Taming the Genie*
- Books: *Extreme Programming Explained* (1999) · *Test-Driven Development: By Example* (2002) · *Tidy First?* (2023)